



Cisco Catalyst Center Operations Guide

Scaling Secure Network Automation Across the Enterprise

This guide is designed to support the client's global network teams as they deploy, operate, and scale Cisco Catalyst Center. Whether you're maintaining daily operations, resolving complex issues, or integrating with enterprise systems, this interactive resource provides practical tools, expert guidance, and clear workflows tailored to real-world use.

Explore the capabilities that matter most, surface proven practices from early rollouts, and build confidence in your day-to-day use of Catalyst Center.

Turn the page or click one of the quick links below:



Getting
Started



Dashboard
Walkthroughs



Troubleshooting
Tips



Integration
Playbook

A Smarter Approach to Global Network Management

Modern network operations are more complex and more essential than ever. Catalyst Center brings clarity and control to the client's global infrastructure by unifying wired and wireless management, automating workflows, and powering decision-making through assurance-driven insights.

This guide supports your role in making that transformation real, on the ground and in real time.

As the Catalyst Center rollout expands across the client's international operations, it becomes increasingly important for every technical team to share a common understanding of how to navigate, utilize, and optimize the platform. Whether you're leading an implementation, troubleshooting performance, or planning for scale, this guide provides structure, repeatability, and support to match your expertise.

Catalyst Center Quick Facts

57 Global Regions

Catalyst Center
Sites Activated

99%

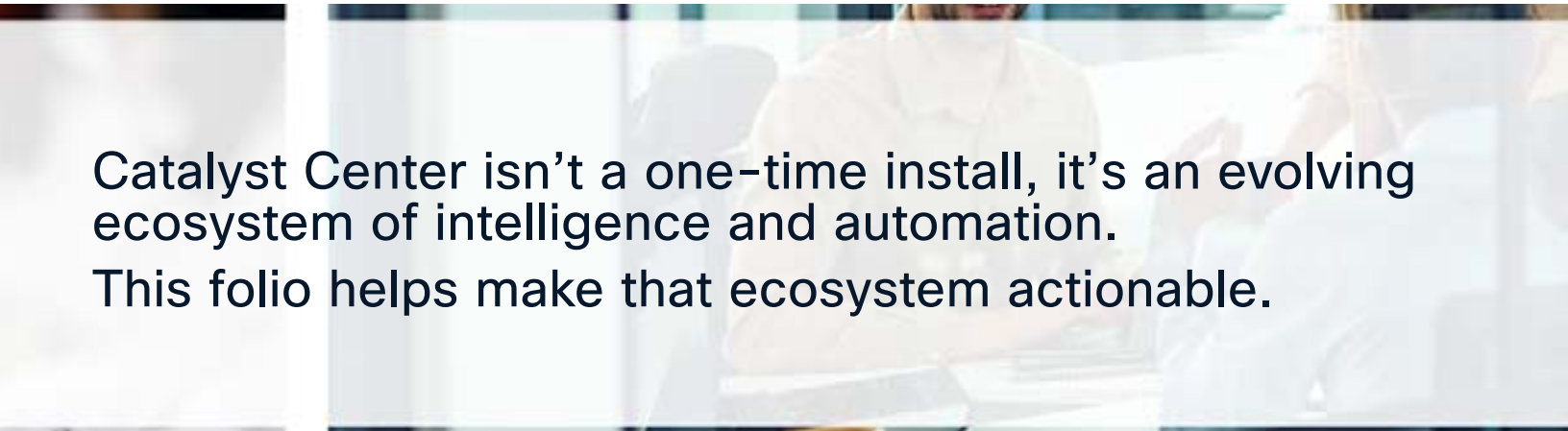
Target Uptime
SLAs

**Endpoint
Visibility +
Automation**

*A Key Use Case

**Tier 1
Rollout
Completion**

Achieved!



Catalyst Center isn't a one-time install, it's an evolving ecosystem of intelligence and automation. This folio helps make that ecosystem actionable.

What Catalyst Center Delivers

Cisco Catalyst Center provides a unified command platform that bridges insight and action. For teams, it's more than just a management tool, it's an essential control layer enabling proactive, automated, and scalable network operations.

This section outlines the foundational capabilities of Catalyst Center and shows how they directly support the tasks you perform every day, from ensuring performance, to enforcing policy, to responding swiftly and intelligently to issues.

Key Capabilities

Image Dashboards

Including health views for network, client, and application performance

Network Services

Visibility and configuration of core services across the fabric

Automation Engine

Streamlined provisioning, compliance enforcement, and config drift control

Software Image Management

Maintain golden images, schedule upgrades, and apply patches safely

Integrated Tooling

Built-in ServiceNow, ISE, Umbrella, IPAM, and ThousandEyes support

Feature	Highlights
Device 360	One-click telemetry and config view per device
Wi-Fi 6 Dashboard	Deep RF visibility and performance insights.
AI Endpoint Analytics	Detect and classify unknown or misbehaving devices.
Template Hub	Rapid config deployment with version tracking

Core Activities for Network Teams

Daily operations are where Catalyst Center proves its value most visibly. This section focuses on the most commonly used tools and actions that help teams maintain network health, resolve issues quickly, and stay compliant, all without slowing down productivity.

Day 2 Operations: What You'll Use Most

Inventory and Visibility

Use Inventory > Device 360 to get a full view of connected devices, their roles, and real-time health.

Compliance and Configuration Drift

Use Compliance Reports to compare configs, track deviations, and validate drift post-change.

AI-Powered Endpoint Analytics

Quickly identify unmanaged or anomalous devices.

Software Image Management (SWIM)

Confirm device firmware and push Golden Images or SMUs.

Wireless and Application Health Dashboards

Use Wi-Fi 6 and App 360 views to link RF issues to client and application behavior.

Events and Event Analytics

Quickly identify, analyze and manage network issues and events.

Understanding these core tools is critical, but what happens when things go wrong?

Even with the best setups in place, network teams inevitably face sudden issues: a device goes offline, wireless performance drops, or a rogue AP appears unexpectedly. Catalyst Center not only helps detect these problems early, it also equips you with guided tools to resolve them efficiently.

In the following reference table, you'll find common issues teams encounter in day-to-day operations, along with the most effective views, diagnostics, and best practices to address them. Think of this as your go-to field playbook for fast triage and resolution.

Top Issues and Quick Fixes

Frequent Network Challenges and How to Resolve Them with Catalyst Center

Each issue listed below includes a **magnifying glass icon**. Click it to open step-by-step screenshots that walk you through the recommended troubleshooting process in Catalyst Center.

Issue #1: Device Offline / Unreachable **Tool:** Inventory → Device 360

Troubleshooting Steps:

1. Trace app-to-user flow
2. Check QoS and congestion
3. Review endpoint telemetry



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Scaling Success Across the Enterprise

As the network grows, consistency becomes even more important than speed. This section outlines practical ways to manage change, maintain standards, and ensure repeatable success across locations.

TAC Tips and Field-Tested Best Practices



Build Your Dashboard for Rapid Triage

Configure the Catalyst Center homepage with top sites, health widgets, and events feed.



Always Start with 360-Degree Views

Start triage using Client 360, App 360, or Device 360 based on the issue type.

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Key Takeaways, Resources, and Support

Cisco Catalyst Center gives teams the tools to manage complex networks with greater clarity and control. From real-time visibility to automated compliance and smart integrations, it supports efficient, consistent operations across regions. With standardized templates, AI-driven insights, and connected workflows, teams can respond faster and scale with confidence.

A strong knowledge network is just as valuable as a strong infrastructure. Whether you need documentation, quick templates, or a teammate to review your next deployment plan,

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